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TRACK A · AI FOUNDATIONS · KIT 2 OF 20

Prompting Basics: Getting Useful Results Every Time

Word-for-Word Facilitator Script: read it aloud exactly as written, or make it your own. Keyed to all 30 slides, with stage directions, a running clock, and answers to the questions staff actually ask.

Facilitator Script · 45–60 minutes

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi

A husband-and-wife team of certified educators with over 20 combined years in the classroom. Adam is a certified CTE Carpentry teacher; Katelyn is a certified K-8 teacher.

How to use this script

Everything in plain type is meant to be spoken aloud. Read it verbatim (it's written for the ear) or glance and paraphrase once you're comfortable. Either way delivers a complete session. Slide cues, stage directions, and question boxes work exactly as they did in Kit 1. If your school hasn't run Kit 1 yet, run it first; this session builds on its two rules (no student PII in public tools; a human reviews everything).

Meet Ms. Rivera. Throughout the deck you'll see the same example teacher's screen: Ms. Rivera, our running composite (not a real person; she appears in every kit). When her screen is up, point the room at it; it's the model to mimic in the lab. If someone asks who she is, say exactly that: a fictional teacher we use across the series so you always see what the work looks like before you try it yourself. Her tracker chip sits top-right on every slide; the matching line under each slide cue below tells you what it says, so you always know what the room is reading.

Timing checkpoints

Clock	You should be...	If behind...
0:12	Starting the four-part formula (slide 9)	Trim discussion on slides 5–6
0:24	Starting iteration (slide 15)	Do two makeovers instead of three
0:30	Starting the lab (slide 18)	Start it anyway; the lab is the session
0:52	On First 48 Hours (slide 31)	Hold the closing lines; hand out sheets at the door

45-minute version: run one iteration round in the lab instead of two, take two share-out voices instead of four, and read the "45-min cut" stage notes where they appear.

From the founders

→ This note is from Adam and Katelyn Spinozzi, the two certified teachers who wrote this kit. It's here to give you their perspective before you present. Sharing it is entirely your call: read parts aloud where they fit, retell them in your own words, or keep it to yourself as background. The session is complete either way.

We're Adam and Katelyn, and here is why this session matters for what happens in your classrooms: the gap between teachers who get real hours back from AI every week and teachers who quit on it in frustration is not talent or technology. It is one learnable skill, knowing how to ask. A teacher who can prompt well turns evenings of drafting into minutes, and spends the difference on students. A teacher who can't concludes the tool is a toy.

The lessons we believe this hour will leave with your staff: the four-part formula (role, task, context, format) that turns vague requests into reliable results; the discipline of iterating instead of settling for a first draft; the honest limit that no prompt, however good, retires your judgment or your duty to verify; and a line we hold personally, that your voice matters most in personal communication with parents and students. In those messages, your voice isn't a finishing touch; it's the substance. Let AI help with the routine and the structural. When the message is personal, the words should be yours.

Segment 1 · Welcome & the gap (slides 1–4)

SLIDE 1 Title

0:00

→ Slide 1 up as people arrive. Start on time.

Welcome back. Last session we agreed on the rules of the road: no student information in public AI tools, and a human reviews everything before it reaches a student or a family. Today is about the skill that turns AI from a curiosity into a colleague: writing prompts that get useful results every time, not just sometimes.

SLIDE 2 The gap

0:01

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her gap: same tools as the weekly savers. The skill is what differs.

Here's the number that explains why this hour exists. In the big 2025 Gallup survey of teachers, about three in ten used AI weekly, and those weekly users saved nearly six hours a week. Meanwhile four in ten teachers didn't use AI at all. Same tools, same access. The difference between those two groups isn't the technology; it's a skill. And the skill is mostly one thing: knowing how to ask.

SLIDE 3 Why "just ask" fails

0:03

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her lesson learned: vague in, beige out. The model only has what she gives it.

Remember what these tools actually are, from Kit 1: prediction machines. They continue patterns. When you give a vague prompt, the model predicts the most likely, most average continuation. That's why vague prompts get generic answers: "Write a lesson on fractions" gets you the most average fractions lesson on the internet. Not wrong. Just beige. The fix isn't magic words. The fix is information: the model can only use what you give it.

If asked "is prompting just a fad until AI gets smarter?" Fair question. Tools do keep getting better at guessing intent. But no tool can guess what only you know: your grade level, your students' needs, your constraints, your taste. Giving that context will matter in five years exactly as much as it matters today.

SLIDE 4 Agenda + one promise

0:04

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her goal: leave owning one reusable prompt for a weekly task.

The hour: first, the anatomy of a prompt that works, four parts, no jargon. Then live makeovers: we take real, vague teacher prompts and fix them in front of you. Then the skill nobody talks about: iterating instead of settling. And then the heart of the session: you build one reusable prompt for a task you actually do every week, and leave with it saved. By the end of the year that one prompt may be worth hours. That's the promise: not theory, inventory.

Segment 2 · The anatomy of a good prompt (slides 5–8)

SLIDE 5 The colleague test

0:05

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her pre-flight: would a colleague with zero context get it?

One test predicts whether a prompt will work before you ever hit enter, and it comes from Anthropic's own documentation: show your prompt to a colleague with no context. If they'd be confused, the model will be too. That's the whole game. The model is like a brilliant new hire on their first day: enormously capable, knows nothing about your classroom, your school, or what you actually want. Write for that new hire.

SLIDE 6 Four parts, every time

0:07

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her formula, from now on: Role, Task, Context, Format.

Across the official guides from OpenAI, Google, Anthropic, and the frameworks state education departments now teach, the advice converges on the same four parts. One: **Role**. Who should the AI be? "You are an experienced 4th grade teacher." Two: **Task**. What exactly do you want? One clear verb. Three: **Context**. What does it need to know? Grade level, prior knowledge, constraints, what you've already tried. Four: **Format**. What should the output look like? A table, a list of five, a one-page letter, a rubric with four levels.

Role, task, context, format. Say it once with me. That's the formula. Everything else today is practice.

If asked "do I need all four every time?" No. For quick tasks, task plus format is often enough. But when output disappoints, the missing ingredient is almost always context. Add it before you give up.

SLIDE 7 Why it works

0:09

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her expectation, calibrated: structure buys measurably better output.

This isn't folklore, though it also isn't a law of nature. Researchers who tested structured, principled prompts against casual ones measured the difference: on the benchmark they built for it, applying a set of clear prompt-design principles improved GPT-4's response-quality scores by about 58 percent. That is one benchmark, not a promise about your Tuesday, so hold it loosely. What it does show is the direction: specific in, specific out. The formula is just a reliable way to be specific.

SLIDE 8 The one thing prompts can't fix

0:10

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her caveat, permanent: no prompt turns off hallucination. She still verifies.

Before the makeovers, one honest limit, because trust lives here. No prompt, no matter how good, turns off hallucination. A beautifully structured prompt can still produce an invented fact or a fake citation, delivered with total confidence. Prompting improves quality and fit. It does not replace verification. The Kit 1 rule rides along forever: anything factual gets checked before you rely on it.

Segment 3 · Live makeovers (slides 9–14)

SLIDE 9 Makeover #1: the lesson plan

0:12

Let's fix real prompts. Round one, the classic. Before: "Write a lesson on fractions." You've seen what that gets. After: "You are an experienced 4th grade teacher. Draft a 45-minute introductory lesson on equivalent fractions for a class that has mastered basic fraction notation but confuses numerator and denominator when simplifying. Include a 5-minute warm-up, a hands-on activity using paper folding, and a 3-question exit check. Format as a table with timings."

Count the four parts with me: role, teacher. Task, draft a 45-minute intro lesson. Context, what they've mastered and where they're stuck. Format, table with timings, specific components. Same request. Completely different result.

SLIDE 10 Makeover #2: the parent message

0:15

→ Her full chat window is the slide, so the tracker chip steps aside here. Point at the four colors as you read.

Round two, communication, and notice the Kit 1 rule working alongside the formula. Before: "Write a note to parents about the field trip." After: "You are a warm, organized elementary teacher. Write a note to families about an upcoming museum field trip. Context: departure 8:30 a.m., return by 2 p.m., students need a bagged lunch and a signed permission slip by Friday. Reading level: accessible to busy families skimming on a phone. Format: under 150 words, with the three action items in a bulleted list." No student names anywhere, and none needed.

SLIDE 11 Makeover #3: differentiation

0:17

→ Her full chat window again, so no tracker chip. This is her leveling spec: grade level, key ideas kept, sentence limits, vocabulary box.

Round three, the one that saves the most time. Before: "Make this easier." After: "You are an experienced 4th grade teacher. Rewrite this passage at a 3rd grade reading level. Keep every key idea and the section headings; this goes to the readers in my room who are a year below grade level. Sentence length under 12 words where possible. Then add a 5-word vocabulary box with student-friendly definitions." Then you paste your passage. The difference between "easier" and a specification is the difference between hoping and knowing.

SLIDE 12 The spice rack

0:19

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her spice rack: constraints, audience, an example, 'ask me questions first.'

Four small ingredients that upgrade any prompt. **Constraints:** "under 150 words," "exactly five questions," "no worksheets that need a copier." **Audience:** "for students who have never seen this word," "for families skimming on a phone." **An example:** paste one question or one paragraph in the style you want and say "match this style." Nothing communicates taste like a sample. **Escape hatch:** tell it "ask me up to three clarifying questions before you start." That one line turns a guessing machine into an interviewer.

SLIDE 13 You try: diagnose the prompt

0:21

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her diagnosis eye: when output disappoints, context is usually missing.

→ Read each prompt; the room calls out the missing part (role, task, context, or format). Brisk, 3 minutes. Answers: A missing context (what grade? what topic focus?). B missing format (what should "help" look like?). C missing task (no verb; it's a topic, not a request). D solid: all four present.

Four prompts on screen. For each one, call out what's missing: role, task, context, or format. A: "Write a quiz about the Revolution." B: "Help me with my struggling readers." C: "Photosynthesis." D: "You are a middle school science teacher. Create a 10-question review on photosynthesis for 7th graders who confuse it with respiration. Mix multiple choice and short answer. Include an answer key."

SLIDE 14 Templates beat memory

0:23

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her template: blanks for topic, grade, count, format. Twenty seconds to reuse.

Nobody writes four-part prompts from scratch at 7 a.m. The professionals save templates: a prompt with blanks. "You are a [grade] teacher. Create a [number]-question review on [topic] for students who [what they struggle with]. Format: [format]. Include an answer key." Fill in four blanks, done in twenty seconds. Today's lab builds your first one, and our staff prompt doc is where they'll live so nobody solves the same problem twice.

Segment 4 · Iterate, don't settle (slides 15–17)

SLIDE 15 The first draft is a proposal

0:24

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her iteration rounds, in order: content, then voice, then details.

Here's the mindset shift that separates people who get real value from people who quit: the first response is not the answer. It's a proposal. In Kit 1 you watched a first draft invent a conference that never happened, and it didn't ship until a teacher read it. Today we make improving that first draft a system. Round one: fix the content. "Question 4 is too hard for the start of the unit." Round two: fix the voice. "This doesn't sound like me; warmer, fewer exclamation points." Round three: fix the details. "Shorten it by a third and make the directions a numbered list."

SLIDE 16 Iterate vs. start over

0:26

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her judgment call: 80% right, iterate. Wrong thing entirely, fresh prompt.

One judgment call: when the draft is eighty percent right, iterate. When it's fundamentally the wrong thing, don't argue with it for ten minutes; start a fresh prompt and put what you learned into the context. Knowing when to quit a thread is itself a skill, and it's one round, not five. Your time matters more than the tool's feelings. It doesn't have any.

SLIDE 17 Voice check

0:27

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her voice check: read it aloud; if it isn't her, she says 'warmer' or 'blunter.'

One more honest limit before the lab, and it's the one your students will someday need to hear too: AI output has a house style. Smooth, agreeable, a little beige. If everything you send home starts sounding like everything everyone else sends home, families notice. So the last iteration round is always the voice round: read it aloud, and if it doesn't sound like you, say so. "Blunter." "Warmer." "I'd never say 'furthermore.'" Your voice is a feature. Keep it.

Segment 5 · The lab: build your reusable prompt (slides 18–26)

SLIDE 18 Lab setup

0:30

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her lab pick, one prompt through every step: her weekly review questions.

→ *Devices out, pairs formed inside two minutes. Announce the tool. Energy up; this is the session.*

Lab time, and today you're not making a throwaway. You're building a tool you'll use every week. Think of one task you do over and over: the Friday newsletter, the weekly quiz, leveling a reading, writing station directions. That's your target. Ms. Rivera builds hers on screen the whole way: one prompt for her weekly review questions, from rough first draft to saved template. Every step has two slides: how to do it, then her actual screen. If you ever feel lost, copy what's on her screen. Ground rules from Kit 1 apply: no student information, and nothing has to be perfect.

SLIDE 19 Lab step 1: draft with the formula

0:32

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her review prompt, step 1: about to draft it with all four parts in.

→ Read the four parts off the slide, then advance to her screen and leave it up for the whole 6 minutes.

Step one: write your prompt with all four parts. Role. Task. Context, and be generous; what would a substitute need to know? Format, exactly what the output should look like. Then run it and read the draft like an editor, not a fan.

SLIDE 20 Lab step 1 on her screen: her first draft

0:33

→ 6 minutes of work time on this slide. Her chat window is the whole slide, so no tracker chip. Circulate. Weak prompts usually lack context; nudge with "what would a substitute need to know to do this right?"

Here is Ms. Rivera's screen. Her first instinct was "make me some review questions for Friday," and that is the prompt most of us would have typed. What she actually sent is underneath it, with the four parts in four colors: she is an experienced 4th grade teacher, she wants a 10-question Friday review on equivalent fractions, her class still confuses numerator and denominator when simplifying, and she wants a mix of multiple choice and short answer with an answer key. Copy that shape with your own weekly task.

READ ALOUD · A worked example

Here's a real prompt, exactly as it's used in a working carpentry program: "You are a furniture designer, digital fabricator, and mechanical engineer. Your task is to construct a rendering of three possible table legs for a 32-inch bar top table that ultimately will be converted to an SVG file and cut as a template on the CNC." Notice the formula working: three roles stacked to get design sense plus manufacturing sense, one clear task, and a format chosen for where the work goes next, an SVG headed for the CNC. Your version won't involve a CNC. The bones are identical.

SLIDE 21 Lab step 2: three rounds of iteration

0:38

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her review prompt, step 2: three rounds of pushback, in order.

→ Name the three rounds off the slide, then advance to her screen.

Step two: three rounds, in order. Content round: what's wrong or missing? Voice round: does it sound like you? Detail round: length, format, level. Push back like you would with a capable student teacher: specific, kind, and completely unafraid.

SLIDE 22 Lab step 2 on her screen: what she typed each round

0:39

→ 6 minutes of work time on this slide. 45-min cut: one round instead of three, then straight to step 3.

Her three messages, exactly as she typed them into the same thread. Content: "Question 3 is mixed numbers; we haven't gotten there. Swap in a comparing-fractions item." Voice: "The directions don't sound like me. Warmer, and lose 'utilize.'" Details: "Exactly ten questions, numbered, answer key on its own page." Nothing clever in any of them. Specific, kind, unafraid, and in that order.

SLIDE 23 Lab step 3: template it and save it

0:44

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her review prompt, step 3: the specifics come out, the doc entry goes in.

Step three: turn what worked into a template. Replace the specifics with blanks: topic, grade, number of questions. Paste the final version into the staff prompt doc with your name and a one-line note about what it's for. Congratulations: you just wrote the first entry in your professional prompt library, and Kit 18 will grow it into a whole collection.

SLIDE 24 Lab step 3 on her screen: her saved template

0:45

→ 5 minutes of work time on this slide. Project the staff prompt doc beside it if you can; watching entries appear live is the session's proudest moment.

The same prompt you watched her draft and iterate, with three specifics pulled out and blanks put in: "You are an experienced [grade] teacher. Write a [number]-question review on [topic] for a class that still confuses [what they mix up]. Mix multiple choice and short answer. Include an answer key." Notice the four colors survive the swap. The structure is the reusable part. Hers sits in the staff doc under her name, labeled "weekly review questions, any topic."

SLIDE 25 Share-out

0:46

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her review prompt, before and after: the delta is the lesson.

→ 3–4 voices, one minute each. Ask one person to read their before AND after; the room hears the delta.

Let's hear a few. Read us your before and your after, and tell us the one change that made the biggest difference.

SLIDE 26 What you just built

0:49

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her library: one entry today, the review-questions template. It compounds.

Notice what happened in fifteen minutes. You went from asking the AI a question to owning a tool. That's the difference between the teachers saving six hours a week and everyone else. It was never about typing faster. It's a small library of prompts that fit your classroom, plus the reflex to push back until the output earns your name on it.

Segment 6 · Making it stick (slides 27–30)

SLIDE 27 The formula on one slide

0:50

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her one-slide system: formula, colleague test, three rounds, template it.

The whole session on one slide. Role, task, context, format. The colleague test before you hit enter. Three rounds: content, voice, details. Template what works, save it, share it. And underneath it all, the permanent rules: no student information in, nothing unreviewed out.

SLIDE 28 Honest limits, again

0:51

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her limits list: can't check facts, know her kids, or pick what matters.

What prompting cannot do, so nobody oversells it in the hallway: it can't make the model check facts, so you still verify. It can't know your students, so you still personalize. And it can't decide what's worth teaching, because that was never a formatting problem. Better prompts buy you time and quality. Judgment stays yours.

SLIDE 29 Our commitments, extended

0:52

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her new norm: working prompts go in the staff doc. Nobody solves twice.

Kit 1 gave us three commitments. Today adds a fourth, and it's the friendly one: when a prompt works, it goes in the staff doc. Nobody at this school solves the same problem twice. Can I get a nod on that?

SLIDE 30 What's next

0:53

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her next kit: the formula starts differentiating for her whole roster.

Next in the series: Kit 3, AI for Planning and Differentiation, where this formula starts doing heavy lifting: leveled texts, scaffolds, and lesson materials for the range of learners actually in your room. Your reusable prompt from today comes with you.

Segment 7 · First 48 hours & close (slides 31–33)

SLIDE 31 Your first 48 hours

0:54

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her 48 hours: run the template for real, one colleague test, one post.

Three small things within two days, each under fifteen minutes: use your new reusable prompt on the real task it was built for. Run the colleague test on one prompt before you send it. And post your template to the staff doc if you didn't finish in the lab. Tomorrow morning, coffee in hand, pick one.

SLIDE 32 Exit ticket

0:55

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her exit ticket: one technique taken, one task still wanted.

→ *Distribute exit tickets; collect at the door. They're the school's PD documentation.*

Two minutes on the exit ticket: one technique you're taking, one prompt you still want help with, one thing you'll try. Your answers steer the follow-ups.

SLIDE 33 Close

0:56

Last word. A good prompt is just clear thinking, written down. You already do the hard part every day: knowing your students, knowing your subject, knowing what good work looks like. Today you learned to hand that knowledge to a very fast intern in a way it can actually use. Keep the thinking. Delegate the typing. Thanks, everyone.

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